STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Ticket Escalation SOP

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Audience	All support tiers, Team Leads, Escalations Desk, on-call engineering
Classification	Internal - do not distribute outside Lumora

Purpose. Defines ticket priorities, service level targets and the rules for escalating tickets between support tiers, to management and to the Safety Officer.

1. Support Tiers

Tier / team	Responsibility
Tier 1 - Customer Care	First contact for all channels: orders, returns, billing, basic setup and troubleshooting.
Tier 2 - Technical Support	Advanced troubleshooting, wiring questions, warranty claims, installer support.
Tier 3 - Product Engineering	Firmware and hardware defects, incident investigation. Accepts escalations only from Tier 2.
Escalations Desk	Complaints involving executives, media, social media or regulators.
Safety Officer	Owner of all safety cases (fire, smoke, burns, electrical shock, swollen batteries).

2. Priority Levels and SLAs

Every ticket is assigned a priority when it is created. The priority can be raised at any time but may only be lowered by a Team Lead. SLA clocks for P1 run 24 hours a day; all other priorities use business hours (Monday to Friday, 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM Eastern).

Priority	Definition	First response	Customer updates	Resolution target
P1 - Critical	Safety hazard, or no heat when indoor temperature is below 50 °F	15 minutes	Every 2 hours	4 hours
P2 - High	System cannot be controlled at all, or an issue affects multiple customers	1 hour	Every business day	1 business day
P3 - Normal	Single device fault with a workaround	4 business hours	Every 2 business days	3 business days

Priority	Definition	First response	Customer updates	Resolution target
P4 - Low	How-to questions, feature requests, cosmetic issues	1 business day	On resolution	10 business days

Table 2-1. Priority matrix.

> **Note:** An SLA alert is sent automatically when 80% of the first response or resolution time has elapsed. Team Leads must reassign or escalate the ticket before the SLA is breached.

3. Escalating Between Tiers

3.1 Tier 1 to Tier 2

Tier 1 agents must escalate to Tier 2 when any of the following applies:

- The issue is not resolved after 20 minutes of active troubleshooting on a call or chat.
- The customer contacts Lumora for the second time about the same issue within 7 days.
- The product guide lists the error code as an escalation trigger.
- The caller is a Lumora Certified Installer.
- The issue involves wiring changes at the HVAC equipment.

3.1.1 How to Escalate in LumoraDesk

1. Complete the handoff summary fields described in section 7.1.
2. Change the ticket group to Tier 2 - Technical Support and keep the current priority unless the escalation criteria require a higher one.
3. Tell the customer that a specialist will contact them and give the response time for the ticket priority from Table 2-1.
4. Do not close or set the ticket to Pending after escalating; the receiving tier owns the next action.

3.2 Tier 2 to Tier 3

Tier 2 escalates to Tier 3 Product Engineering when a firmware defect can be reproduced, or when a hardware failure pattern appears in units from the same production lot (the lot code is the 4-digit number after the model prefix in the serial number). The escalation must include the serial numbers, firmware versions, steps to reproduce and logs exported from the app. Tier 3 acknowledges escalations within 1 business day and may return a ticket to Tier 2 if required information is missing. Tier 2 keeps ownership of all customer communication while Tier 3 investigates.

Incident rule. When three or more customers report the same issue within 24 hours, Tier 2 must open an Incident ticket (INC) and page the on-call engineer, even if the issue cannot yet be reproduced. All matching customer tickets are linked to the INC ticket as children and set to P2.

The incident owner posts a status update for agents every 4 hours until the incident is resolved, and Customer Care Operations decides within 2 hours whether a banner message is shown in the app.

4. Safety Escalations

Any report of smoke, fire, a burning smell, scorch marks, melted terminals, electrical shock or a swollen battery is a safety case. Safety cases are always P1, regardless of the product or the customer's request.

1. Instruct the customer to switch off power to the HVAC system at the circuit breaker. If there is smoke or fire, tell the customer to leave the building and call emergency services, and end troubleshooting.
2. Create or update the ticket as P1 with the category Safety.
3. Notify the Safety Officer through the safety hotline queue within 1 hour of the first report, at any time of day.
4. Ask the customer to keep the device and not to discard it. Do not request photos while there is any ongoing hazard.
5. The Safety Officer informs Tier 3 Product Engineering and Legal within 24 hours and owns all further customer communication.

> **Important:** Agents must never suggest that a safety case was caused by the customer, and must not offer compensation. Compensation for safety cases is decided only by the Safety Officer.

5. Management Escalations

- **Customer asks for a supervisor:** create a callback task for a Team Lead. The Team Lead must call back within 4 business hours.
- **Social media, press or regulator mentions:** route to the Escalations Desk the same business day. Agents do not respond publicly.
- **Executive complaints** (emails addressed to company officers): handled only by the Escalations Desk, first response within 1 business day.

6. Goodwill Credits

Goodwill credits compensate customers for poor experiences, such as missed callbacks or repeated contacts. They are issued as store credit and do not replace refunds owed under the Returns and Refunds SOP.

Role	Maximum credit per ticket
Tier 1 agent	$25
Tier 2 agent	$75
Team Lead	$200
Customer Care Manager	Above $200

Table 6-1. Goodwill credit limits.

A customer can receive at most one goodwill credit per 90 days without Customer Care Manager approval. Credits are not given for safety cases (see section 4).

7. Handoff and Closure Requirements

7.1 Handoff Summary

Every escalation must include a summary with these fields:

- Customer name, account email and device serial numbers
- Problem statement in one sentence and when it started
- Troubleshooting already done, with results
- Customer expectation and any commitments made
- Priority and SLA deadline

7.2 Warm Transfers

P1 and P2 escalations by phone must be warm transfers: the agent stays on the line and introduces the case to the receiving agent. If no agent is available within 5 minutes, the ticket is escalated in LumoraDesk and the customer is told when to expect a callback.

7.3 Closing Escalated Tickets

Escalated tickets may only be closed after the customer confirms the issue is resolved, or after three contact attempts over 5 business days without a reply. The closing note must state which of these applied.

8. Priority Examples

Use these examples to set the priority consistently. When a ticket matches more than one example, use the highest priority.

Situation	Priority	Route to
Customer smells burning plastic near the thermostat	P1	Safety Officer and Tier 2
No heat, indoor temperature 47 °F, outdoor temperature 20 °F	P1	Tier 2
No heat, indoor temperature 62 °F	P2	Tier 2
Thermostat offline in the app but heating works	P3	Tier 1
Room sensor battery drains in 3 months	P3	Tier 1
Twelve customers report E12 after the same firmware update	P2 (INC)	Tier 2, then Tier 3
Customer asks how to set a vacation schedule	P4	Tier 1
Customer threatens to post a complaint video online	P3	Escalations Desk

Table 8-1. Priority examples.

9. Reporting

Customer Care Operations publishes a weekly SLA report showing breaches by priority and team. Two or more P1 breaches in a calendar month trigger a review with the Director of Customer Experience.